colon is divided into the ascending colon, which goes up in the right side of the abdomen to the level of the liver; the transverse colon that crosses the abdominal cavity below the liver and descending colon, that descends in the left side of the body; and the S shaped sigmoid colon, which enters the rectum, where feces is stored. When sufficient amount of feces is collected, the rectum opens at the anus, where defecation occurs. The internal and external anal sphincters help to keep the orifice closed. Getting rid of indigestible remains is the means by which the large intestine helps to maintain homeostasis.

2.1.2 Secretory Organs

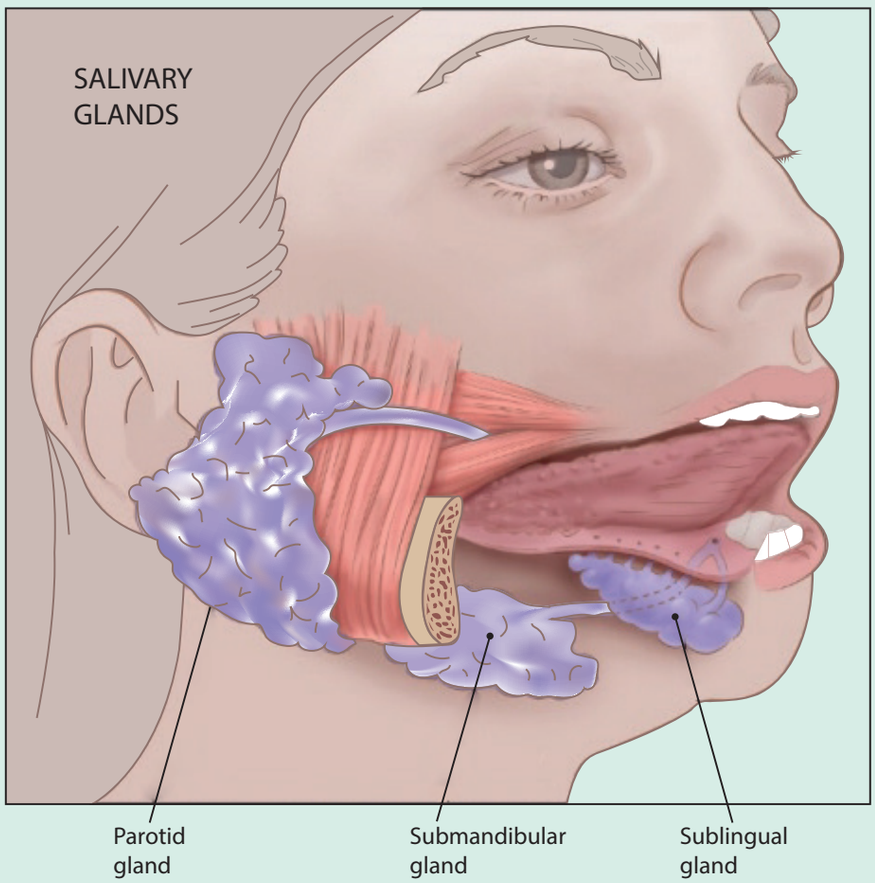


Figure 2.6 location of salivary gland

2.1.2.1 Salivary Glands

There are three pairs of major salivary glands namely, the parotid glands present inferior and anterior to the ears, the submandibular glands located in the floor of the mouth and the sublingual glands beneath the tongue and few minor salivary glands that are present in the cheeks, lips and palate (Figure 2.6). The secretion called saliva from the major salivary glands reaches the mouth by Stenson's duct, Wharton's duct and Bartholin's duct. Approximately, an average man secretes about 1 to 1.5 liters of saliva per day. Saliva is 99.5% water and the remaining is mucus, electrolytes, anti-microbial agents and enzymes. The water helps in dissolving the food and thereby stimulates the taste

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